



PSPO I STUDY NOTES

Get ready for your certifications

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1. Key Content

To prepare for the exam, you need to be familiar with fundamental knowledge about Scrum framework and the way it is being applied in different aspects of day-to-day works.

1.1. SCRUM

- Scrum is founded on empirical process control theory or **empiricism**.
- Scrum can be used for sustaining **complex products**.
- Scrum has rules.
- Using timeboxes **limits work in progress**.
- Scrum is “considered” as a framework, not a methodology, process, techniques. It can be used to develop new products or maintain/sustain existing ones.
- There are no baselines in Scrum.

The timeboxed duration of events is as follows:

- **Sprint** — Maximum 1 month
- **Daily Scrum** — 15 minutes
- **Sprint Planning** — 8 hours in one month Sprint, normally shorter in shorter Sprints
- **Sprint Review** — 4 hours in one month Sprint, normally shorter in shorter Sprints
- **Sprint Retrospective** — 3 hours in one month Sprint, normally shorter in shorter Sprints
- **Scrum values are commitment, courage, focus, openness, and respect. (F-O-R-C-C)**
- **Scrum artifacts are Product Backlog, Sprint Backlog, and Increment. (P-S-I)**
- **Scrum pillars are transparency, inspection, and adaptation. (T-A-I)**
- Velocity is the average amount of work done per Sprint.
- Scrum allows additional meetings if they facilitate achieving the Sprint Goal.
- When **multiple teams** are working on the same product, one person can be a member of more than one Developers.

- **The performance** of the **project** is measured at least **once per Sprint** (by the Product Owner), and the **Sprint performance** is measured **daily** (by the Developers).
- All teams should be cross-functional in scaled Scrum.
- **The essence of Scrum is a small team of people.**
- The individual team is highly **flexible** and **adaptive**. These strengths continue operating in single, several, many, and networks of teams that develop, release, operate and sustain the work and work products of thousands of people. They collaborate and interoperate through sophisticated development architectures and target release environments.
- Only members of the Developers create the Increment.

"Formal opportunities for inspecting and adapting": ("Feedback Loops")

- Sprint Planning,
- Daily Scrum,
- Sprint Review,
- Sprint Retrospective.

There are 2 meetings in which people outside the Scrum Team are allowed to participate.

- The Sprint Review,
- The Sprint Planning.

The team model in Scrum is designed to optimize: (F — C — P)

- Flexibility,
- Creativity,
- Productivity.

Which of the following best describes transparency?

Significant aspects of the process must be visible to those responsible for the outcome.

Who are the typical Key Stakeholders?

- **The Users** — The human people who actually use the product under development
- **The External Customers** — The people responsible for paying to use the product

- **The Internal Customers** — The people responsible for making the funding decisions for the product development effort
- The Developers is free to change their engineering practices whenever they want.
- Budgeting done in Scrum ideally revised each Sprint to ensure value is being delivered.
- Measuring the performance of the Sprint and using Sprint Backlogs are required/mandatory.
- All increments must be **potentially releasable** to enable usable feedback.
- Scrum doesn't have a project manager role. The project management activities are distributed among the three Scrum roles.
- Working at a **sustainable pace** is one of the Agile principles. This helps increase productivity and quality.
- All Scrum roles, events, and artifacts are necessary and should not be ignored for any reason.
- Developers creates the increment
- The Key Stakeholders are allowed to participate only in the Sprint Review meeting.

1.2. SCRUM TEAM

- Scrum Team roles are Product Owner, Developers (Development Team), and Scrum Master.
- Scrum Team delivers potentially useful and releasable products.
- Scrum Team is responsible for tool selection and configuration.
- Scrum Team is responsible for setting the timeboxed duration of Sprints.

There are only three roles in Scrum:

- Product Owner, Scrum Master, and Developers.
- It's not allowed to define new roles and the Developers should not have any titles; they are all just "developers". It is so, because we want all of them to be accountable for everything and to collaborate with each other.
- Each person has his/her own area of expertise, such as testing, and that person will be more focused on testing tasks, but it doesn't mean that we can call the person "tester"; they are just developers who are experts in testing.

Scrum Team is self-organized and cross-functional:

- Self-organized: Choose how to best to accomplish their work.
- Cross-functional: Team has all competencies, skills to accomplish their work.
- A cross-functional team is one that has all types of expertise that is required to develop the product. Note that this is about the team as a whole, not individual team members.

Scrum Team is designed to optimize:

- Flexibility,
- Creativity,
- Productivity.

The Scrum Team consists of:

- The Scrum Master,
- The Product Owner,
- The Developers.

1.2.1. Product Owner

Product Owner must be 1 person.

- There can be a committee for product ownership, but only their representative will be called the Product Owner. So, there's only one Product Owner, even when there are multiple teams. This person can be full-time or part-time. One person can have more than one role in Scrum (e.g. both the Product Owner and the Scrum Master). While it's not forbidden, it's not recommended either.
- The Product Owner is the **value maximizer** of the Scrum Team, is a single person (never a committee, or a PMO), solely responsible for prioritizing the product backlog. He/She can choose any of the decision points to make priority decisions: value, priority, risks, and dependencies. (S)he could even appoint a delegate to interact with the Product backlog on his/her behalf.
- There can be one Product Owner for each product.
- Product Backlog's order and composition, project performance measurement, and release planning are the Product Owner's responsibilities.

- Product Owner is responsible for **managing Product Backlog** (Ordering items, achieve **goals and missions**).
- Creating new Product Backlog items, ordering them (**prioritization**), and making sure everyone has a clear understanding of them is the responsibility of the Product Owner.
- Product Owner is responsible for the monitoring of the remaining work towards the Project Goal.
- The product Owner is responsible for engaging stakeholders, understanding them, communicating with them, and so on.
- Product Owner ensures the Developers understands items in the Product Backlog.
- Product Owner **can delegate** her/his responsibilities to the Developers.
- Product Owner has the **authority to cancel the Sprint**, no one else has this authority.
- Product Owner decides when to release the product.
- Measuring the performance of the release or project performance is the responsibility of the Product Owner while measuring the Sprint performance is done by the Developers.
- Product Owner's main responsibility is maximizing the value of the product.
- Product Owner creates and orders the Product Backlog items and makes sure that everyone understands them.
- Product Owner may not order the Developers to do things; the Developers is self-organized. (self-managed)
- The Product Owner can also be a member of the Developers (It's not recommended but also possible).
- Estimating the **size or amount of work required for each item is done by the Developers**, but estimating value, which is different from size is done by the Product Owner.

What's the role of a Product Owner in composing the Sprint Goal?

- They bring **business objectives** to the Sprint Planning meeting, and they work with the rest of the team to craft the Sprint Goal.

What does Product Owner do during the Sprint?

- Works with stakeholders,
- Answers questions from the Developers about items in Sprint backlog.

What's the role of a Product Owner during Sprint Retrospectives?

- Participating as a Scrum Team member.

When there are n teams in a project, there are:

- **1 Product Backlog**
- **n Sprint Backlogs each Sprint**
- **One or more Definitions of Done, as long as they are compatible with each other**
- **1 integrated Increment each Sprint**
- **1 Product Owner**
- **n Scrum Master roles which can be occupied by 1 or more Scrum Masters**

Note 1: one project is about one product.

Note 2: The way Scrum Guide explains it, it sounds like there should be one Definition of Done for scaled Scrum, but [Scrum.org](https://www.scrum.org) believes that there can be multiple definitions, as long as they are compatible with each other and capable of creating integrated Increments, and that's what you have to answer in your exam.

Which KVA (Key Value Area) categories should the Product Owner consider to measure and track the creation and delivery of value to the market place?

- Current Value,
- Time-to-Market,
- Ability to Innovate.

In executing Value Driven Development, the Product Owner must consider the focus areas of:

- Product Value Maximizer,
- Product Visionary,
- Product Marketplace Expert,
- Product Release Decision Maker,
- Lead Facilitator of Key Stakeholder Involvement,
- Other Product Owner role Considerations.

What are the three most applicable characteristics of the Product Owner?

- Product Value Maximizer,

- Lead Facilitator of Key Stakeholder Involvement,
- Product Marketplace Expert.

What factors should be considered by the Product Owner in the release decision?

- The risk that the product's value can get out of line with the marketplace
- Can customers actually absorb the new release?
- Does the Increment meet the Definition of "Done"?
- The customers that will be constrained by the new release

1.2.2. Scrum Master

- Scrum Master is responsible for coping with incomplete artifact transparency. This work usually involves **learning, convincing, and change**.
- Scrum Master can also be the Product Owner.
- Scrum Master role is a management role, but they **manage the process**, not the people.
- Scrum Master is responsible for promoting and supporting Scrum.
- One Scrum Master can manage multiple Scrum teams.
- Scrum Master is responsible for ensuring Scrum is understood and enacted.
- Scrum Master **facilitates** Scrum events (if requested).
- Scrum Master **removes impediments** for the Developers's progress.
- Scrum Master helps the Product Owner to find techniques for arranging the Product Backlog effectively.
- Scrum Master leads the team for Scrum adoption.
- Scrum Master's job is to increase the **transparency of artifacts** with learning, convincing, and change.

Scrum Master serves the Product Owner in several ways, including:

- Ensuring that goals, scope, and product domain are understood by everyone on the Scrum Team as well as possible.
- Finding **techniques** for effective Product Backlog management.
- Helping the Scrum Team understand the need for clear and concise Product Backlog items.
- Understanding product planning in an **empirical environment**.

- Ensuring the Product Owner knows how to arrange the Product Backlog to maximize value.
- Understanding and **practicing agility**.
- **Facilitating** Scrum events as requested or needed.

Scrum Master can detect incomplete transparency:

- **Inspecting** the artifacts,
- Sensing patterns,
- **Listening** closely to what is being said,
- Detecting differences between **expected and real results**.

1.2.3. Developers

- Developers's size should be min 3 — max 9.
- Developers delivers potentially useful and **releasable products at every end of the Sprint**.
- The role within a Scrum Team is accountable for managing, organizing, and doing all development work required to create a **releasable increment** of product every Sprint.
- The technical approach is completely up to the Developers.
- **Self-Organizing**: No one tells how they should work.
- **Cross-Functional**: Have all the skills to make them no need from outside of the team.
- Developers **estimates** the effort to complete a Product Backlog item after clarifying the requirement.
- There are no titles in the Developers.
- Measuring **Sprint performance** is the Developers's responsibility.
- Developers themselves will decide on how to form the teams when multiple teams are composed for a single project.
- Developers members can change during the Sprint, with the concern of creating a short time reduction in productivity.
- Developers deal with non-functional features incorporating them into every increment.

Developers is responsible for;

- Managing the Sprint Backlog,
- All estimates,
- Do all the work required for Product Backlog items.

What does Developers do during the Sprint?

- Runs the Daily Scrums,
- Measuring the Sprint Backlog,
- Ensures the tasks are **Done** based on the "**Definition of Done**",
- Decides on the way of the work and on the technical approach (Self-Organizing).

1.3. SCRUM EVENTS

1.3.1. Sprint

- The next Sprint begins immediately after the conclusion of the previous Sprint
- Once a Sprint begins, its duration is fixed and cannot be shortened or lengthened.
- The purpose of a Sprint is to have a **working increment** of the product;
- Duration is maximum one month.
- An increment of potentially releasable product functionality must be created
- There are **no Sprint Zero, Hardening Sprints, Release Sprints, Integration Sprints in Scrum.**
- Sprint Planning, Daily Scrum, Sprint Review, and Sprint Retrospective are **all considered "feedback loops"**.

During the Sprint

- If work's different than expected, the **scope can be re-negotiated** between the Product Owner and the Developers.
- Sprint Goal can't be changed.
- New Sprint tasks can be added as soon as possible after they are identified unless reflecting a scope change in the Sprint Goals.
- No changes are made that would **endanger the Sprint Goal**;
- Quality goals do not decrease;

When a Sprint is canceled

- For any part of work that is potentially releasable, the Product Owner typically accepts it.

- Incomplete Product Backlog items re-estimated and moved into Product Backlog.
- The total work remaining to reach a goal can be summed any time, the Product Owner tracks it.
- Only the Product Owner has the authority to cancel the Sprint.

Sprint Goal

- **Sprint Goals** are set during Sprint Planning meetings.
- Sprint Goal helps you **focus on the outcome** that is expected from the Sprint.
- **Sprint Goal is created by the whole Scrum Team** not only Developers.
- The whole Scrum Team is responsible for setting the time-boxed duration of Sprints.
- **All the Scrum Teams working on the same product should have the same Sprint length. → FALSE**
- The purpose of each Sprint is to create a **potentially releasable** piece of software. It **doesn't have to be released**.
- Each Sprint starts immediately after the previous one; there's **no space between the two**.
- This is important for [Scrum.org](https://www.scrum.org) that you know this because many people add gaps between Sprints to do different things such as refinement, which is not productive.
- After the Sprint Retrospective of the previous Sprint, which means there's no prerequisite for Sprint Planning.
- During Sprint Planning the Scrum Team crafts/prepare a Sprint Goal. Cannot be changed during a sprint(unless the goal is invalid and the PO cancels the sprint).

1.3.2. **Sprint Planning**

- Sprint Planning is time-boxed for **8 hours or shorter**.
- Developers works to **forecast** the functionality that will be developed (Product Backlog items)
- Scrum Team crafts a Sprint Goal after the Developers forecasts Product Backlog items it will deliver.
- Sprint Planning one of the opportunities for inspection and adaptation.

The input to the Sprint Planning is:

1. The Product Backlog, prioritized.
2. The latest product Increment
3. The projected capacity of the Developers during the Sprint
4. **Past performance** of the Developers

1.3.3. Daily Scrum

- Daily Scrum is time-boxed for **15 minutes every day**. (At the same time and place).
- Developers is responsible for conducting the Daily Scrum.
- Developers use Daily Scrum to **inspect progress**, work together as a self-organizing team, and key to adapt.
- Developers tracks the total work remaining to manage its progress.
- Daily Scrum is an opportunity for **inspection and adaptation**.
- Daily Scrum is for the developers; only they “participate” (=talk). Others can “attend” (=watch).

1.3.4. Sprint Review

- Sprint Review is time-boxed for **4 hours or shorter**.
- Scrum Team and stakeholders collaborate about what was done and undone in the Sprint.
- Developers demonstrates the work that it has Done.
- Sprint Review is an opportunity for inspection and adaptation
- Sprint Review is an informal meeting with the customer.
- Sprint Review meeting is an **inspection of the Increment** to collect **feedback** and see **what to do in the next Sprint**.
- The result of the Sprint Review is (mandatory for the Scrum Team)
 - o Inspected Increment
 - o A **revised Product Backlog** that defines the probable Product Backlog items for the next Sprint.

The Sprint Review contains much more activities to inspect the Increment and adapt the Product Backlog.

For example:

- The Product Owner also explains what has not been “Done”.
- The entire group collaborates on what to do next so that the Sprint Review provides valuable input to subsequent Sprint Planning.

- Review of the timeline, budget, potential capabilities, and marketplace for the next anticipated releases of functionality.

1.3.5. Sprint Retrospective

- Sprint Retrospective is time-boxed for **3 hours or shorter**.
- Sprint Retrospective inspects itself and creates a plan for **improvements** to be enacted during the next Sprint.
- Inspect the last Sprint **relationships, process, and tools**.
- Create a plan for implementing improvements to the way of Scrum.
- Chance to improve Scrum process to make it more **effective and enjoyable** for next Sprint.
- An opportunity for inspection and adaptation.
- The purpose of the Sprint Retrospective is to: (mandatory for the Entire Scrum team)
 - Inspect how the last Sprint went with regards to **people, relationships, process, and tools**;
 - Create a **plan for implementing improvements** to the way the Scrum Team does its work.

1.4. SCRUM ARTIFACTS

1.4.1. Product Backlog

- The **Product Owner owns the Product Backlog**.
- Product Backlog describes everything that is needed in the product.
- Product Backlog has **just enough details, not all the details**.
- Product Backlog is the source of everything that might be needed in the product.
- Product Backlog is never complete, it's **dynamic**.
- Product Backlog **grows with feedbacks** and becomes a larger and more exhaustive list.
- Multiple Scrum Teams work together on the same project should use **one Product Backlog**.
- More precise; important, clearer, and **more detailed items at the top**, least items at the bottom
- Items at the bottom of the Product Backlog are usually larger than the top.
- Large items on the top of the Product Backlog are **broken down into smaller ones to become clearer**.

- Developers doesn't spend more than 10% of their time on Product Backlog refinement.
- It provides just enough information to enable the team to develop the product.
- Burn-down chart measures work remaining across time.
- The ownership of items is shared, therefore, there's no need to record it in the item.
- **Product Goal** - the product goal describes a future state of the product ... [It] is the **long-term objective** for the Scrum team.
- Product Backlog items have the attributes of a description, order, estimate, and value. Product Backlog items often include test descriptions that will prove their completeness when "Done" and Dependencies.
- Multiple teams are working on a product: 1 Product = 1 Backlog = 1 Product Owner = 1 Product vision

What does a trend line through a release burn-down chart indicate?

- When the remaining work will likely be completed if nothing changes in the Product Backlog or the Developers.

There are 3 pieces of information in each Product Backlog item:

- Description (in the form of a User Story or otherwise),
- Value,
- Estimate.

Product Backlog Refinement is

- Is the act of adding detail, estimates, and order to Product Backlog items.
- Is an ongoing process.
- Usually takes no more than 10% of the capacity of the Developers.

1.4.2. Sprint Backlog

- Sprint Backlog is **owned by The Developers**. Not the whole Scrum Team.
- Sprint Backlog is managed by The Developers. Not the whole Scrum Team.
- Sprint Backlog is selected Product Backlog items + Plan for delivering them.

- Sprint Backlog **can be changed or modified** in the Daily Scrum and throughout the Sprint.
- When the element of the plan is deemed unnecessary, they are removed.

1.4.3. Definition of Done

- Definition of Done is a **shared understanding** within the Scrum Team on what it takes to make your Product Increment releasable. Can be updated during retrospectives.
- Definition of Done shouldn't change in the middle of the Sprint.
- Definition of Done **can change during the project.** (can be improved during the project. However, it shouldn't change in the middle of the Sprint.)
- Definition of Done is changed by the Developers, not the Product Owner.
- Definition of Done may be composed by the organization but inside the project, only the developers may change or define it.
- Definition of Done is adjusted by the Developers, not the Product Owner.
- Definition of Ready is not accepted in [Scrum.org](https://www.scrum.org).
- Everyone must understand what Done means.
- Multiple Scrum Teams working on the same project, there can be multiple definitions, as long as they are capable of creating a potentially releasable Increment.
- Non-functional features/requirements can be added to the Product Backlog or even baked into the Definition of Done.
- Helps the Developers have a reliable forecast of the number of items they can select in the Sprint Planning.
- Defines what it takes for a Product Backlog item to be ready for release.
- Creates transparency for the Increments that will be inspected at the Sprint Review
- Increases **transparency of the Increments.**
- Can be improved during the project.
- Used by the developers to forecast how many items they can pick for the Sprint.

What should be taken into account for the Definition of "Done"?

- Definition of “Done” of other Scrum Teams working on the same Product.
- Conventions, standards, and guidelines of the organization.

1.5. Incompatible with SCRUM framework:

- Project and Product Managers
- Nothing should be baselined in Scrum
- Scrum Masters/Product Owners don't order people (servant leadership)
- There are no roles other than those three standard ones, and none of them manage the rest.
- **Decoupling Release from Sprint timeboxes:** The product increment should be usable and potentially releasable at the end of every Sprint, but it does not have to be released. Similarly, increments can be released as many times within the duration of the Sprint.
- **Performance:** POs measure the performance of an increment by **metrics such as customer satisfaction**, stakeholder engagement, **revenues**, etc. **NEVER by velocity, burn down charts**, how well the team collaborates, **individual performance**, etc.

Forget your past! If you have experience using Scrum, chances are high you're not doing it perfectly. Scrum.org asks you many questions about the common wrong behaviors in Scrum projects, and that's why you should use your knowledge instead of what you've seen in the projects.

2. Exam Preparation

After you acquire the fundamental knowledge above, it's time to prepare for the Exam.

2.1. Question types

The exam is composed of 3 question types. Below is a breakdown of the approximate ratios:

- Multiple Choice : ~65%
- Multiple Response : ~30%

- True / False : ~5%

(Choose the best answer) and (Choose the best # answers)

Not all questions will contain answers that are purely right or wrong, there will also be some cases where any answer can be valid however you can't choose them all. Keep in mind that you are seeking the **best answer(s)** rather than the right answers.

Example of a Multiple Response question:

Which of the following is true about the first Sprint?

(choose the best two answers)

- ☒ It results in a potentially releasable Increment.
- ☐ It is focused on creating Sprint Backlogs for subsequent Sprints.
- ☒ At least one piece of functionality is developed.
- ☐ It is used to determine and finalize the project plan.
- ☐ The first Sprint should not begin until the architecture and infrastructure is in place.

True / False

Focus on whether you believe the presented statement is true or not rather than thinking about whether an opposite statement is true or not. A True/False question is only asking about the presented statement, so don't overanalyze by justifying your answer by seeking an opposite statement.

Example of a True/False question:

True or False: Scrum is a method to incrementally build software through specifically defined steps and processes.

- ☐ True
- ☒ False

Understanding how the exam is structured and how the question types work will allow you to focus more on the context of the questions.

2.2. Easy, Hard, and Tricky Questions

Some questions will be easier than others. Below are the types of questions new exam takers will experience.

“Easy” questions

I consider anything that can be explicitly found in the Scrum Guide as an easy question. For example, time-boxes, which events are used for what purpose, what are the artifacts, etc. If you know and remember the specific contents of the Scrum Guide, you should have no problem answering these types of questions.

Example of an “easy” question:

Which of the following are accountabilities defined in Scrum?

(choose all that apply)

- ☒ Developers
- ☐ End Users
- ☐ Stakeholders
- ☒ Product Owner
- ☒ Scrum Master

“Harder” and not so obvious questions

These answers typically cannot be found in the Scrum Guide but are implicit so will involve a bit deeper thinking. The Scrum Guide is written with the assumption that you understand the **underlying concepts and foundation** from which Scrum is built.

Example of an implied question:

Which of the following is considered the desired benefit of having time-boxes?

(choose the best answer)

- ☒ Helping to limit work-in-progress.
- ☐ Ensuring that all planned items will be finished on time.
- ☐ Maximizing the velocity of the Developers.

- ☐ Helping the Product Owner determine which “Iron Triangle” attribute to adjust.

“Tricky” questions

If a question feels like a trap or ambiguous, reread the question and all answers carefully. Questions are not meant to trick you and there are no “trick questions”.

Remember, the exam assesses your knowledge and understanding of Scrum and only focuses on that. The grammar and vocabulary of the questions are important to correctly interpret the question and will make answering it much easier.

Separate your personal experience. There’s a good chance that your organization used Scrum incorrectly. Some questions will focus on common anti-patterns and bad habits when Scrum is done wrong. For example, there are no Sprint 0 or hardening Sprints in Scrum.

Example of question that might feel tricky:

Which of the following is Product Owner work that the Product Owner might delegate?

(choose the best answer)

- ☐ Writing User Stories.
- ☒ Ordering the Product Backlog.
- ☐ Updating the Scrum Board.
- ☐ Attending the Sprint Planning.
- ☐ Creating acceptance criteria.

2.3. Things that are not in the Scrum Guide

Not all questions will focus on the Scrum Guide. Because it’s a framework, you will need to know how to detect when boundaries are violated.

Tools, practices, and processes not mentioned in the Scrum Guide

There will be some terms that are external to Scrum but can be used to help Scrum Teams. You won't need to be a knowledge expert, however, it's good to know how certain **tools and practices can be used** within the Scrum Framework.

Below are some concepts, tools, and practices mentioned on the exam and what you should know:

- Burn-down charts — used to visualize progress and the work remaining across time
- Feedback loops — each event in Scrum is a feedback loop
- Tuckman's model — you only need to know that productivity is likely to decrease, in the short term, when people/teams are added to or removed from an existing initiative.
- Architecture & Infrastructure — structural requirements that are built alongside functional requirements
- Feature teams — cross-functional teams that can create and deliver fully functional features
- Non-functional requirements — work that is not typically visible to end-users or stakeholders (ie performance, security, technical debt)
- Technical Debt — the eventual consequences of poor technical choices and directly impacts transparency and productivity

Example of a tools question:

Sprint burn-down charts can be helpful:

(choose the best answer)

- ☒ To indicate the total work remaining for the Sprint.
- ☐ To know how many hours each Developer has worked.
- ☐ For the Scrum Master to manage the tasks.
- ☐ To indicate if more people are needed on the team.

2.4. Scenario-based questions

Scrum in practice.

The Scrum framework is purposely incomplete and only guides the relationships and interactions of the people using it. As such, there will be

some questions describing scenarios and asking how to best respond within the context of Scrum.

If the question is asking how a Scrum Master should respond to a problem people are having, the best answers would be anything connected to coaching, mentoring, teaching, facilitating, or supporting the team in self-problem solving. Answers that suggest a **Scrum Master agree with or disagree with an opinion or prescribing a solution are usually incorrect**. For example, what a Scrum Master should do if a Developer notifies him of a data security issue.

Example of a Scrum Master scenario question:

As a Scrum Master, what should you do if a Developer tells you that he discovered a critical security issue?

(choose the best answer)

- ☐ You confirm the issue with the test team.
- ☐ You create a new item in the Product Backlog to fix the issue.
- ☐ You add it to the Definition of Done.
- ☒ You ask the Developer to share the issue with the Scrum Team as soon as possible.
- ☐ You postpone the Sprint until the issue can be resolved.

If the question is asking how a Product Owner or Developer should respond when faced with a problem, the best answer would be one that has the most flexibility. The best answers are the ones that are related to **transparency, self-managing, and enacting one of the Scrum values**.

Example of a Developer scenario question:

What should a Developer do if an influential stakeholder asks him to work on an important item that was not a part of the Sprint Planning?

(choose the best answer)

- ☐ Add it to the bottom of the Sprint Backlog.
- ☐ Replace an item with equal size in the Sprint Backlog.

- ☐ Immediately work on the item and continue on Sprint Backlog items after it has been completed.
- ☒ Notify the Product Owner so he can work with the stakeholder.

2.5. Be aware of these words!

NOT!

"Which of the following is **NOT** a responsibility of..."

"All of the following are responsibilities of... **EXCEPT** for..."

Sadly, many people miss these capitalized **negative words** and pick the wrong answer. This is more common when the question is more complicated and you become so engaged in assessing the correctness of the statements that you forget the question was asking for the wrong statement instead of the right one.

Be very careful with this type of question, and pay serious heed to it if you make this mistake in your simulated exams.

Details

Take these statements:

The Product Owner can **attend** the Daily Scrum meetings.

The Product Owner can **participate** in the Daily Scrum meetings.

Are these statements true or false?

The first one is simple: It's true. The second one, however, is false because "**participate**" **implies engagement**, whereas everyone except the Developers members is only supposed to be observing.

There are many questions like this, where a single word changes everything. You need to be careful with it.

Modal Verbs

The Product Owner **can** attend the Daily Scrum meetings.

The Product Owner **should** attend the Daily Scrum meetings.

While the first statement is true, the second one is false, and it's all because of the modal verbs. It's correct that the Product Owner is allowed to attend the meeting, but it doesn't mean that it's necessary for them to be there.

In case you're wondering, in the exam, **"can" means "may"**, and **"should" means "ought to"/"required to"**, similarly to the way English is used by most people nowadays.

Be careful with some verbs in English:

"Attend" and "Participate"

Example: The sentence "Product Owner can **attend** the Daily Scrum" is true ✓ while the sentence "Product Owner can **participate** in the Daily Scrum" is false. ✗

"Accountable" and "Responsibility"

Example: The Product Owner can delegate some of his/her **responsibilities** to the Developers. However, the Product Owner remains **accountable**.

"Could" and "Should"

Example: The sentence "Product Owner could attend the Daily Scrum" ✓
"Product Owner should attend the Daily Scrum" ✗